Beyond Data: AI for Human Connection

SYNC

Human-Centered Data Entry

Good data starts with the people entering it.

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StratusLIVE

Speakers

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Agenda

- Why Data Quality Starts With People
- Understanding Why Bad Data Happens
- Designing Better Forms in Dynamics 365
- Reducing Entry Burden With Automation
- Building a Culture of Data Consistency
- Listening to Your Users
- How StratusLIVE is Applying These Principles – Peek at new gift entry prototype

1

Why Data Quality Starts With People

The single biggest variable in data quality is the person at the keyboard.

The Human Side of Data Quality

Data quality is a human experience problem

We spend a lot of time on validation rules, database design, and integrations — and those things matter. But the single biggest variable in your data quality equation is the person at the keyboard entering data every day.

That is an empowering insight. It means the path to better data is not just about system configuration — it is about making the experience of entering data better for the humans doing it.

2

Understanding Why Bad Data Happens

Bad data is rarely a people problem — it's a system and workflow problem.

Four Patterns That Undermine Data Quality

Friction

As teams grow and workflows evolve, steps that once felt seamless can start to feel like extra effort — leading to shortcuts and guesswork.

Inconsistency

Even with good standards, interpretations drift as new team members join. Small variations compound into fragmented, unreliable data.

No Feedback Loop

Most people entering data never see how it is used downstream. Closing that loop changes how seriously people take data quality.

The Fourth Pattern: Workarounds

- Shadow spreadsheets alongside the system
- Memo fields used as catch-alls
- Required fields filled with N/A or 000
- Steps everyone skips without saying so

→

- A workflow has outgrown its configuration
- Users need something the system isn't providing
- An opportunity to improve the experience
- Your roadmap for what to address next

3

Designing Better Forms in Dynamics 365

Small form improvements deliver major data quality gains at scale.

Designing Better Forms

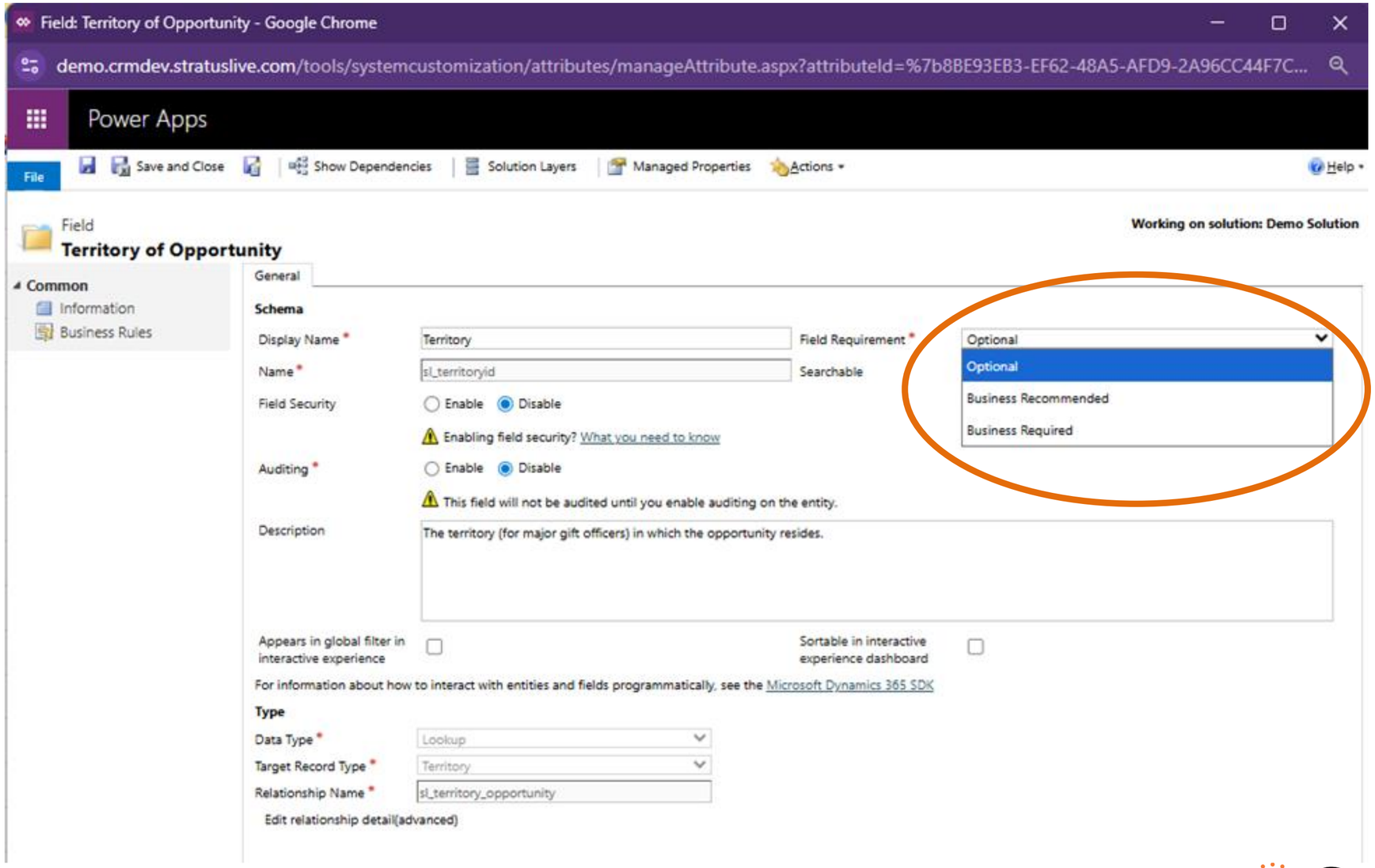
Tip: If users regularly enter “N/A” or “000” in a required field, that field is generating garbage data — not protecting it.

Field ordering, required fields, and tooltips

Organize forms around how your team thinks through a task — not how the database is structured. A form that matches your workflow produces faster, more accurate entry.

Required fields and field-level tooltips are simple to configure and high impact: every unnecessary gate is a burden, and every ambiguous field is an opportunity for someone to guess wrong.

Required Fields



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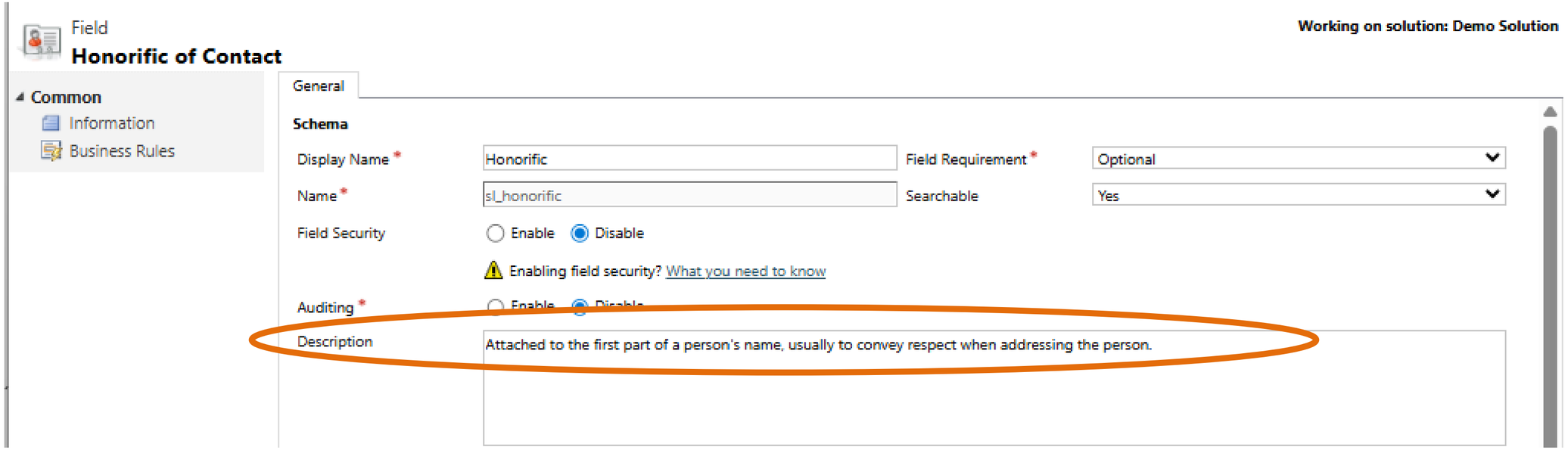
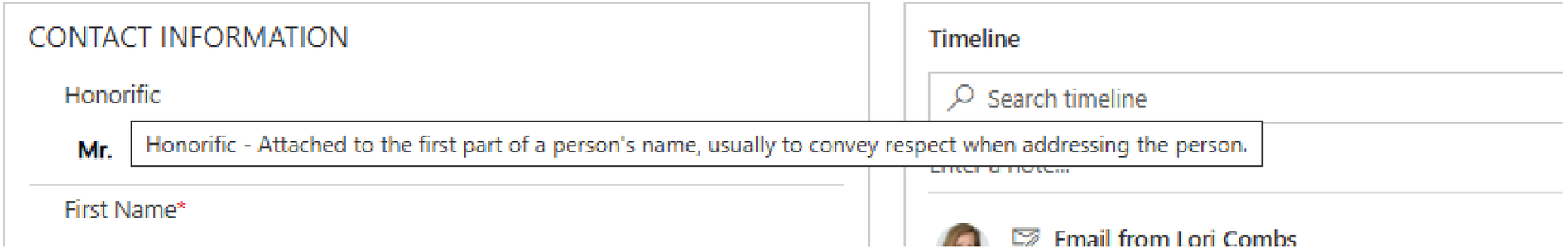
Tool Tips


Field
Honorific of Contact
Working on solution: Demo Solution
Common
Information
Business Rules
General
Schema
Display Name *
Honorific
Field Requirement *
Optional
Name *
sl_honorific
Searchable
Yes
Field Security
Enable
Disable
Enabling field security? What you need to know
Auditing *
Description
Attached to the first part of a person's name, usually to convey respect when addressing the person.


CONTACT INFORMATION
Honorific
Mr.
Honorific - Attached to the first part of a person's name, usually to convey respect when addressing the person.
First Name*
Timeline
Search timeline
Email from Lori Combs

Designing Better Forms

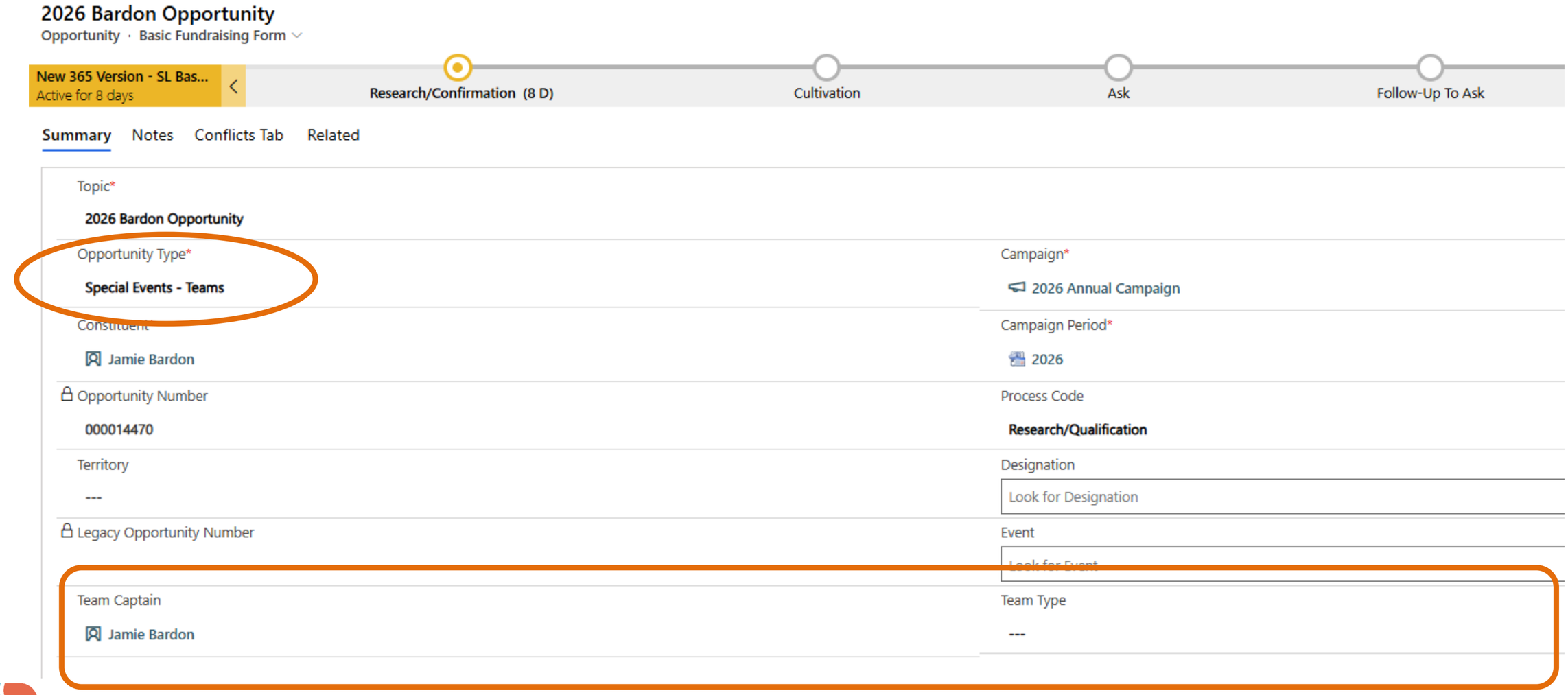
Key: Every configuration layer you add is a step the user no longer has to think about.

Business rules and filtered lookups

Business rules let fields show, hide, lock, or auto-populate based on context — so users only see what is relevant to them at any given moment. This reduces cognitive load and the chance of errors.

Filtered lookups are worth reviewing as your data grows. Tightening filters so users see only the records relevant to their task is a simple configuration change that pays off quickly.

Business Rules



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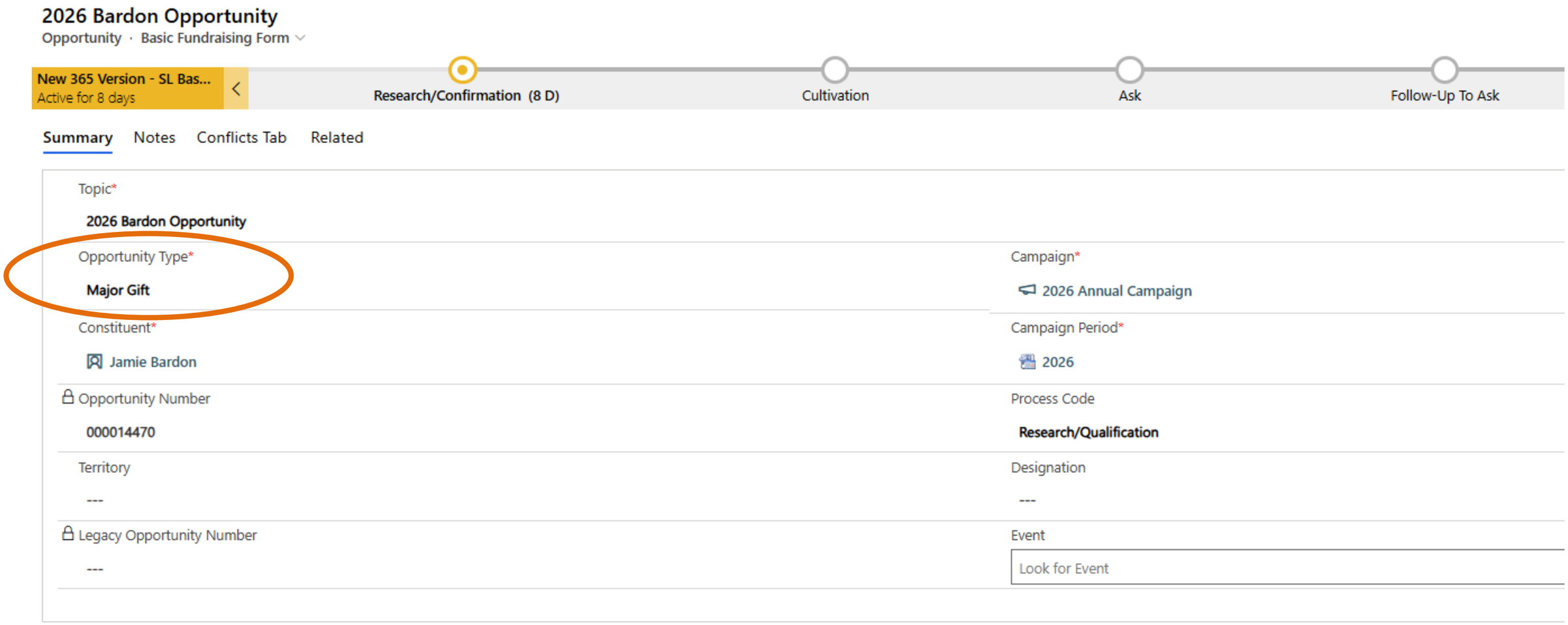
Business Rules



No Team Captain or
Team Type fields

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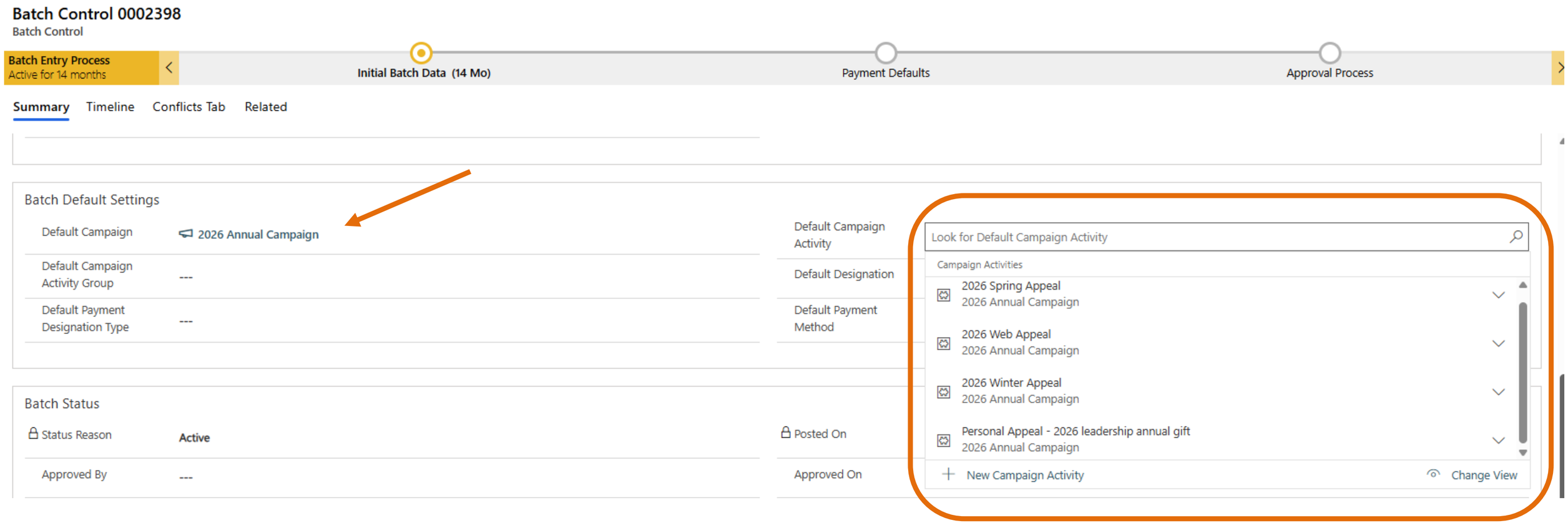
Filtered Lookups



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4

Reducing Entry Burden With Automation

The best data entry is data entry that doesn’t have to happen.

Your Automation Toolkit

01

Default Values

Pre-fill what you already know

02

Duplicate Detection

Catch problems at the point of entry

03

Workflows

Automate downstream field population and record creation

04

Quick Create Forms

Streamlined entry for high-volume tasks

Third Party Data Enrichment

SmartyStreets

Provides address validation, adds zip+4, geocoding, and CASS certification to standardize address data.

Wealth Screening

Wealth screening services can be integrated and have the results available on the prospect's record.

Other Services

Programs like Data8 or Melissa Data for data validation and cleansing.

5
Building a Culture of Data Consistency

Technology takes you far. Culture takes you all the way.

Three Pillars of Data Consistency

Living Data Standards

Document how names, addresses, and key fields should be entered — and review those standards annually as your team and workflows evolve.

Option Sets Over Free Text

Wherever you see variation in how people answer a field, a dropdown is usually the fix. Structured choices produce data you can actually report on.

Data Stewards

Embed a data champion on each team — not an IT role, but someone who answers questions, notices patterns, and bridges daily users with system configuration.

6

Listening to Your Users

The people doing daily entry know exactly where the friction is.

Creating a Feedback Culture

Your team members know exactly where their workflow feels clunky or unclear. Most of the time, they assume nobody wants to hear it. Set up a lightweight feedback channel — a shared inbox, a Teams channel, a short monthly check-in — and signal that you are listening. Then treat your forms and configuration as a living part of the system, not a finished product.

- Watch for workarounds — they are your roadmap
- Schedule periodic form reviews — even once a year
- Quick wins build trust and keep feedback flowing

Start Small
High impact, low effort changes go first

Three Things to Take Back to Your Team

Make the right thing easy

Configuration and automation should guide users toward accurate entry naturally — without relying on memory or extra effort.

Data quality is a team sport

It is not owned by IT alone. It lives in the space between the system, the standards, and the culture — and improving it is a shared effort.

Small improvements compound

Refining a few workflows, tightening a few lookups, automating a few manual steps — applied consistently, those changes add up to significantly better data across thousands of records.

7

How StratusLIVE Is Applying These Principles

Let's look at our gift entry prototype

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Questions?

Thank you for joining this session. We would love to hear what is on your mind.

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